

1.1 The Early Years

Steven Paul Jobs (co-founder and chief executive officer of Apple, Inc. and co-founder of Pixar) was introduced to Stephen Wozniak (co-founder of Apple, Inc.) by a mutual friend, Bill Fernandez, in 1971. Jobs and Woz developed a companionship over the next few years and started thinking of making a commercial logic board. Woz was to do the engineering and Jobs the marketing of the product. Manufacturing and selling a product publicly for profit, however, would require a corporate identity, and the geek duo had none. After much cajoling, Stephen Wozniak signed the ten-page document that would give a 90 per cent stake in the newly-established company in equal divisions to both Jobs and Woz. Ron Wayne, a friend and helper of Jobs from his former employment at Atari, was to receive the remaining 10 per cent. After a series of rejected names, Woz came up with the name “Apple,” and it clicked as the perfect name to both of them. It sent out a message that this was a company willing to go against tradition and try out things differently, and above all, it preceded Atari—their main competitor at the time—in the Address Book.

Paul Terrell, the owner of *The Byte Shop*, a computer store in their locality, expressed an interest in the machine when Jobs approached him but demanded that it should require no manual assembling. If Jobs and Woz would be able to meet his requirements, he promised to order fifty units at \$500 a piece. They had an order worth \$25,000. “This was the biggest single episode in all of the company’s history,” said Woz. “Nothing in subsequent years was so great and so unexpected.” They were on the verge of starting a computer business.

Certain that he had already sold fifty computers before even beginning work on them, Jobs ordered the parts needed to build the computer at a big supply house, Kierulff Electronics. But, of course, he did not have any money to buy the components, and the shop owner declined to sell the goods on credit unless Steve could prove his credibility. When asked how he was going to pay for the